

This short text, known as the Dhāraṇī for a Melodious Voice (in Sanskrit likely

Toh 792 · Derge Kangyur

This short text, known as the Dhāraṇī for a Melodious Voice (in Sanskrit likely *Svaravāhinī* or a similarly titled dhāraṇī, and in Tibetan associated with the term *sgra snyan*), is a concise ritual and mantra manual centered on the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara. It opens with homage to the Three Jewels and the mantra formula "Om bhagavati śruti smṛti bala bala parama siddhe svāhā," followed by instructions for a seven-day practice in which the mantra is recited over water that is then drunk, promising enhanced memory and, with sustained practice, a voice as melodious as that of a kinnara. As a dhāraṇī text, it belongs to the tantric or ritual-spell genre of Buddhist literature, offering practical means for cultivating mental and vocal excellence through mantric empowerment. This work is catalogued as Toh 792 in the Kangyur, situating it among the collection's dhāraṇī and ritual texts associated with esoteric practice.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Om bhagavati śruti smṛti bala bala parama siddhe svāhā.

As for the ritual: for seven days, each morning, before the noble Avalokiteśvara, one should cast the mantra seven times over a handful of water and then drink it. Even after a single day, one will be able to memorize three hundred śloka's worth of letters. If this is done for a month, one's voice will become as melodious as that of a kinnara (a mythical being renowned for its sweet voice). One should have no doubt about this.

The Dhāraṇī for a Melodious Voice is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase "འདྲིམ་མཚན་མཚན་མཚན་" (rendered here as "each morning") is somewhat unusual in construction; it could alternatively mean "repeatedly, day by day," though the practical sense—performing the rite daily throughout the seven days—remains the same regardless.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.